FUTURE CITY FELLOWSHIP · MILESTONE 2 · JULY 21, 2026

Q&A Backup Pack

Anticipated questions with evidence-grounded answers — not presented; used only if asked.

Every answer traces to canonical contract v1.0.0 (2026-07-19) or a named project artifact. If an answer is not known: say so, and name the artifact or request that will resolve it.

Q&A BACKUP · ANTICIPATED QUESTION 1

“Your demand numbers are simulated. Why should we trust any of this?”

Our answer

- We don't ask you to trust the demand numbers — they are synthetic and uncalibrated, and the contract labels them that way on every row. We ask you to trust the decision logic that survives that uncertainty.
- The strategy is built to be wrong safely: 2–3 starter ports serve any plausible near-term demand; expansion waits for observed utilization, not forecasts.
- Scenario spread (base / high / stress) brackets the uncertainty: portfolio active ports land between 44 and 48 by 2046 in all paths.
- First pilot year replaces synthetic demand with metered data — that is the point of the staging.

Source: contract v1.0.0 assumption flags (demand synthetic_uncalibrated) · scenario_table.csv base/high/stress columns

Q&A BACKUP · ANTICIPATED QUESTION 2

“Why did you not present an ROI or payback period?”

Our answer

- A defensible ROI needs real utilization, adopted tariffs, and a fee policy — none exist yet (0 of 12 sites High confidence; no fee policy adopted).
- We instead compare screening-class net present cost of strategies against each other: staged beats broad day-1 buildout by $0.31M (2036), $0.34M (2046), $0.39M (2056).
- Avoided-cost framing matches the client's actual pain: Neabsco's ~$1,000/station/yr for underused stations is a negative return we can design out.
- Publishing an ROI now would imply precision the data cannot support — the same honesty discipline as the rest of the deck.

Source: contract v1.0.0 lifecycle_cost_npv fields (screening-class) · ECONOMIC_AND_FUNDING_BRIEF.md

Q&A BACKUP · ANTICIPATED QUESTION 3

“Your electrical capacity numbers are placeholders. Doesn't that undermine the ranking?”

Our answer

- Correct, and we say so on every capacity slide: capacity_basis = placeholder at 12 of 12 sites.
- The ranking is driven mostly by siting factors that are real today (location, access, equity indicators, site type); capacity confirmation is a gate before design freeze, not an input we pretend to have.
- Data requests to Dominion and facility managers are drafted for the top-3 sites — the single highest-value action to retire this limitation.
- If confirmed capacity contradicts the placeholder at a site, the site re-ranks — the model is built to accept that.

Source: contract v1.0.0 capacity_basis/capacity_source fields · human_actions/utility_facility_data/ request drafts

“How would your equity trigger actually work?”

Our answer

- Design intent: expansion triggers combine an observed-utilization threshold with an equity override, so a site in an underserved area can expand on a lower threshold — status today is 'proposed policy, not adopted; awaiting observed data'.
- Each site row carries an equity indicator (e.g., FFX002 0.66, PWC002 0.769) so the override has a data hook.
- The honest gap — how to set the trigger when early utilization data are sparse — is exactly our peer question; we are asking for help, not claiming the answer.
- Adoption belongs to the city/county governance layer, not to our team or model.

Source: contract v1.0.0 equity_indicator + expansion_trigger_status fields · peer question (ranked 95/100)

Q&A BACKUP · ANTICIPATED QUESTION 5

“Prince William County is already building a 35-station fleet hub. Are you competing with it?”

Our answer

- No — the county's ~35-station fleet hub (in design, per [client contact]) is their real parallel track; our scope is public sites, and alternative D exists to keep that distinction honest.
- We coordinate: siting and load planning should not duplicate hub coverage, and hub lessons (ADA clustering redesign cost, reported by both the client and Dominion) feed our layouts.
- If the client tells us fleet is the 24-month priority, the frame flips and our model becomes a siting layer inside the fleet program — that is a client decision, recorded as such.
- Fleet duty-cycle data does not exist yet, which is why we do not model the hub ourselves.

Source: client interview record (July 2026) · 04_ALTERNATIVES_BRIEFING.md row D

“Aren't you counting on federal money that may not exist?”

Our answer

- No funding is awarded, applied for, or implied anywhere in the plan — that sentence appears in our funding brief verbatim.
- Primary path is the Dominion Level 2 Charging Program: 50% upfront make-ready, remainder on-bill over 10 years, 100% incentive in disadvantaged communities; eligibility and queue still require direct Dominion confirmation.
- NEVI is treated strictly as upside: its history (Feb 2025 freeze, June 2025 court-ordered release, Aug 2025 interim guidance; $885M FY2026 apportioned; Virginia solicitations anticipated Q1 2026) is too volatile to be a base assumption.
- The staged design keeps each increment small enough to fund locally if every external source falls through.

Q&A BACKUP · ANTICIPATED QUESTION 7

“Why UL 2594 and UL 3600 as your highlighted standards?”

Our answer

- UL 2594 (3rd ed., 2022) governs the exact equipment class we propose — AC Level 2 EVSE — so it is the safety standard with real procurement teeth (NRTL listing required in bids).
- UL 3600 (2023) anchors the sustainability requirement with something measurable: vendor circularity disclosure at procurement and annual circularity reporting, instead of vague green claims.
- Supporting law as adopted: 2020 NEC via the 2021 Virginia USBC (eff. 2024-01-18) — the 2023 NEC is not Virginia law; Access Board accessibility rule is still at NPRM, so we design to TA guidance.
- UL 2202, UL 9540/9540A, NFPA 855 are conditional only — no DC fast charging or battery storage is in scope at any site.

Source: FINAL_STANDARDS_APPLICATION_MATRIX.md (verified 2026-07-19) · standards_register.csv

“What does your MATLAB/Simulink model actually show?”

Our answer

- Honestly: it is a supporting load-behavior illustration, not a validated result — it runs on the same placeholder capacity values, and its outputs carry the placeholder caption.
- The Python pipeline is the model of record; every number quoted today comes from its canonical contract (v1.0.0, run 2026-07-19).
- No MATLAB simulation results are claimed in this presentation — the licensed-execution and capacity-basis gaps are logged in the improvement backlog (adapter reconciliation is item 1).
- When real service capacity arrives, the MATLAB layer becomes useful for managed-charging design (alternative E's operating layer).

Source: 17_FINAL_RESEARCH_HANDOFF.md §17.4 · limitations panel ('No MATLAB simulation results are claimed')

Two ready alternates

Backup 1 (ranked 86/100)

“What evidence would you require before converting EV-ready conduit into active charging ports at a public site — and who should own that decision?”

Backup 2 (ranked 76/100 — use only with careful phrasing)

“How would your team keep a 30-year electrification model honest when the client's own 10-year sustainability goals are already off-track?”

Phrasing care: aimed at model honesty as a shared craft problem — never at any client's performance.

Source: 11_PRESENTATION_AND_PEER_QUESTION_RESEARCH.md §3 (peer-question MCDA)

Never say — always say

- Never: 'the client approved / endorsed / chose'. Always: 'the client's interview evidence shaped; the follow-up package is prepared, not yet held.'
- Never: 'the sites have capacity for'. Always: 'placeholder capacity pending utility/facility confirmation at 12 of 12 sites.'
- Never: 'it will cost $X'. Always: 'screening-class estimate — never a budget or quote.'
- Never: 'the team chose staged pilots'. Always: 'the provisional comparison ranks staged pilots first (85/100); the team adopts or amends it.'
- Never: 'our proposed standard' as if it exists. Always: 'a fellowship design concept for a standard.'
- Never: 'NEVI will fund'. Always: 'NEVI is volatile upside; Dominion L2 is the primary candidate path, unconfirmed.'
- Never: quote 2023 NEC as governing. Always: '2020 NEC via the 2021 Virginia USBC, effective 2024-01-18.'